

work connections, freeze or crash your system, alter computer settings, or allow unauthorized access to your system resources.

By running regular antivirus scans, you can rest assured that your computer is well-protected. It's important to choose an antivirus program that not only scans your system but also scans all of your downloads for potential threats. This will help keep your computer and your personal data safe from harm.

Clean the keyboard

You might be surprised at how much dust and debris can accumulate underneath your keyboard's keys. Food crumbs, pet hair, dirt, and other particles can easily get stuck between the keys, leading to sticky or unresponsive buttons. Fortunately, it's easy to clean out these hard-to-reach areas using a compressed air canister, which can be purchased at office supply stores, computer stores, and hardware stores.

For external keyboards, start by unplugging the keyboard from the USB port or turning it off if it's wireless. Tilt the keyboard upside down and shake out any loose debris. Then, use the compressed air canister to blow air at an angle, about 1 inch away from the keys. Use a damp microfiber cloth to finish cleaning, wiping away any remaining dust or grime.

If you're using a laptop, power it off and unplug any USB or power supply inputs. Tilt the laptop upside down and gently tap it to encourage any loose debris to come out. Set the laptop back in its normal position and use the compressed air canister to spray between the keys from about 1 inch away, moving from one side of the keyboard to the other. For tough spots, you can use a cotton ball dipped in isopropyl alcohol, which evaporates more quickly than water and is less likely to damage your computer.

It's important to avoid pouring any liquids onto your computer's body, as water and electronic devices don't mix well and could cause severe damage. By following these simple cleaning tips, you can keep your keyboard and computer free of dust and debris, ensuring that your device performs well and looks its best.

Update the passwords

Updating your passwords is just as important as backing up your data, and it's crucial for protecting your digital world against cyber criminals. In fact, according to Verizon's 2017 Data Breach Investigations Report, 81% of hacking-related breaches are caused by stolen or weak passwords. Poor password behaviour can include using the same password for every account, as well as using simple and easy-to-guess passwords like "password" or "123456".

To ensure the security of your accounts, it's essential to use strong passwords. Here are some tips for generating strong passwords:

1. Use at least 10 characters
2. Include a mix of uppercase and lowercase letters
3. Use numbers and special symbols
4. Consider adding emoticons if possible, such as :(or :D or :O or T.T

A strong password can protect your data against potential third-party hackers, which is why it's an essential part of basic computer maintenance. Remember that no security system is foolproof, so updating your passwords regularly is an important step to take in protecting your digital world.

Why should you follow all these tips?

These tips are important because they help ensure the longevity and performance of your computer, as well as protect your personal data from potential threats. From maintaining a well-organized file system to regularly updating your operating system and antivirus software, these tasks help prevent issues such as overheating, malware infections, and system crashes. Additionally, taking steps to optimize battery life, protect against physical damage, and back up important data can help you avoid costly repairs and irretrievable loss of information. Overall, incorporating these tips into your computer maintenance routine can save you time, money, and stress in the long run. 